

MOVIE

Captain Marvel

★★★★☆ | You can just watch this movie as brainless entertainment and go away totally satisfied. The action never lets up. Essentially you keep jumping from one thing to another, and there is always something on screen to marvel at. Rich and detailed alien cities, hand to hand combat, train+car chase sequence, aerial combat, escape sequences, gun fights, family reunions, virtual reality landscapes, epic space battles - this movie has everything that makes movies fun to watch. All of that is interspersed with familiar characters (Ronan, Fury, Korath and Coulson), as well as the expected punchlines, which at times are literally just kinetic energy punches. You can walk away from this movie exhilarated, because of the sheer



spectacle it offers. But, there is more. A lot of themes are juggled. The movie is set in the 90s which just gives you an overdose of nostalgia. You can see old school objects, vehicles and technologies around. The small irritating things about technologies at that time, includ-

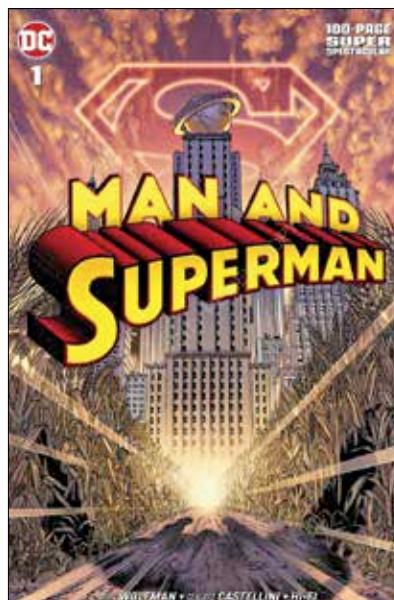
ing pagers and large desktop computers are explored, which is a treat for people living in this age. There are also shout-outs to fashion at that time (flannel jackets were rebellious back then). The movie explores various relationships between Captain Marvel and the Kree, the Krulls, Fury and her best friend, all of which are fun to watch. There is some really smart political commentary going on, with an exploration of xenophobia, and how advanced societies can treat the marginalised, and those that are not as developed. This movie is a great platform for that considering that there are actual alien species involved. And yes, there are some feminist themes explored, but the movie does not shove any agenda down your throat. Captain Marvel has a fleshed out development arc. As a member of the Starforce, she is asked to suppress her emotions, and do everything that it takes to complete her missions. Her training revolves around controlling her impulses. Eventually, she starts using her emotions, unlocking her full potential in the process.

COMIC BOOK

Man and Superman

★★★★★ | Marv Wolfman is a known legend in the comic book industry, having writing credits for the iconic Crisis on Infinite Earths and The New Teen Titans for DC Comics. He's also known to have co-created Blade in his stint with Marvel Comics. He's known to have written Superman as well for Action Comics, including a relaunch of the character during the Crisis limited series. Man and Superman is another timeless story from him and artist Claudio Castellini, that explores a coming of age story of the alien immigrant on Earth.

This 100-page one-shot explores the time when Clark moves from Smallville to Metropolis to achieve his dreams. Now, you would imagine Clark's dream



would be to find out his purpose with all his superpowers. However, this short story tells us more about Clark's personal aspirations and dreams. Wanting to be a writer and a reporter, Clark moves to Metropolis to bag a job at the reputed Daily Planet publication. All this

while being aware of his powers and the good he can do with them. What we liked in this comic is the depiction of how human Superman is actually is. It also shows his early days of transitioning to Superman, before he even gets that name. Juggling between trying to pursue his reporter dreams and saving the people of Metropolis, we get to see Clark facing his insecurities. It is refreshing to get to see more of Clark rather than Superman, giving us a better idea of how he feels about everything as his human self. Another thing that we absolutely loved was the panels that showed his interactions with his parents, who always supported his dreams along with his greater purpose as a superhero. It's clear that a positive upbringing and values are equally responsible for what makes Clark turn into Superman apart from his superpowers.

If you're a Superman fan, you wouldn't want to miss it. Those who want to know what makes Superman 'Super', apart from his powers, give this one a read.